

Green PFM II — Feasibility Study

Mission Meeting Notes

Kigali Field Mission — May 4-9, 2026 | Consultant: Yoan Raih

INTERNAL — Not for external circulation

MINECOFIN — DG Debt

Date	2026-05-04
Time	11:00-12:30
Axis	B
Counterpart attendees	Gerard Gakunzi (Acting DG Debt) Nick Darrant (adviser)
Mission team	Yoan Raih (Consultant) Emmanuel Carrère (Consultant)

Key Points

- DG Debt has three functions: Back Office, Middle Office (MTDS, DSA, analytical work), and Front Office (shared with Development Finance Department and BNR). The team is lean at 7 staff (down from 9), and carries a significant analytical workload.
- Sustainable debt instruments are actively being explored: AfDB is providing an ESG loan (with JPM/ADF), a Sustainability-Linked Loan (SLL) is in progress, and a Debt for Carbon Swap mechanism is under legal negotiation. Standard Chartered and Societe Generale are involved in trade financing via ECA and SOE guarantees.
- The Climate Finance Unit (CFU) is identified as a significant capacity gap: it needs support on MRV for climate finance, legal negotiations on debt-for-climate instruments, and coordination with MINECOFIN's Climate Department.
- On domestic market development: MTDS strategy seeks to diversify and reduce cost both externally and domestically. Domestic investors lack familiarity with ESG instruments — investor capacity building is flagged as a prerequisite for domestic green bond market development.
- MINECOFIN's alignment with the CMA green bond guidelines was confirmed as a reference point, and RBA (supported by IFC) is conducting investor training — a coordination entry point.

Open Questions

- Is there appetite on the government side for the Debt for Carbon Swap?
- What specific MRV support does the CFU need?
- How does DG Debt coordinate with MINECOFIN's Climate Department on SLF KPI reporting?

Potential TA Leads

Area	Description	Priority
CFU capacity building	Targeted TA to MINECOFIN's Climate Finance Unit on MRV frameworks, legal structuring of debt-for-climate instruments, and coordination protocols with the Climate Department.	HIGH

Sovereign SLB/SLL KPI framework (B1.1)	Support DG Debt in designing and expanding the KPI framework for sovereign sustainability-linked instruments, anchored on the MTDS and existing SLF structure.	HIGH
Domestic investor education programme	Design a structured programme to build domestic investor familiarity with ESG instruments, coordinated with CMA and RSE.	MEDIUM